

Metropolitan Library System

Information and Imagination for Our Community

Operating Hours

Starting June 1, the Central Library will be open until 9 p.m. on Tuesdays. We will close at 4 p.m. on Monday afternoons in June and August.

The following branches will be open until 9 p.m. on Mondays and Thursdays:

- Pheasant Ridge
- South Town
- Wensleydale

Look for updated fall hours in the August newsletter.

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Happy Birthday!

It's time to celebrate 75 years of information and imagination with the Friends of the Metropolitan Library System. This family happy birthday event starts with a picture book reading marathon in the Central Library's lower level. Come hear local elementary school teachers read their favorite books. The outdoor courtyard will be busy with area musicians, including the Paper Moon Orchestra and the Guerrero String Band. The Second Avenue Bakery will provide birthday cake and lemonade.

The Friends of the Metropolitan Library System provide volunteer support, as well as fundraising for special projects that the Library could otherwise not afford. Founded by Donna Mae Jasper, a former librarian at the Central Library, the organization has grown to over 1000 members. The Friends annual book sale is a major source of revenue for the Library.

The Friends of the Library Celebration honors our generous volunteers and donors. At the afternoon awards ceremony, we will unveil our new Wall of Library Heroes, which lists our top five hundred donors and volunteers. If you're interested in adding your name to the list, join the Friends of Library today by contacting Josh Hampton at 317-555-0100. We welcome your help and support in the coming year.



Getting Around Town

We're happy to report that the Metropolitan Library System has received a summer operating grant to help fund the City Outreach Bookmobile. This means the Bookmobile will maintain a regular schedule of neighborhood stops, with librarians on-board to check out books and other media, and help patrons make selections. The complete schedule is not final yet, but the Bookmobile will definitely make appearances throughout the county all summer long. You can expect to see it at the Saturday afternoon farmer's market on Ridge Lawn Avenue and at the Cumberland Flea Market the second Sunday of every month. The final schedule will be available on our website by early April.



Book Festival Reminder

Don't forget the annual Indianapolis Tri-County Book Festival, coming up in September. This week-long event includes readings and presentations by your favorite authors. Tickets are available now via our website. You can also buy tickets at the Central Library's front desk, or at your neighborhood branch.



A Fond Farewell

After 25 years of excellent work as our chief reference librarian, Otis Boswell is retiring next month. A reception in his honor will be held in September during the annual Tri-County Book Festival. Otis began his work at the library as the children's room manager. As chief reference librarian, he oversaw the renovation of the Technology Center, dramatically improving our audiovisual services. He is a native of eastern Arkansas, with a master's in library science from the University of Texas at Austin.

Heard Any Good Books Lately?

Did you know that fifty percent of library patrons have never tried an audio book? A world of fun and learning awaits! Check out our ever-growing collection of unabridged titles, offered through the Listening to Literature Collection®. Downloaded audio books can be played on any computer, tablet, smartphone, or other portable digital audio device. Start with any of the classics listed below.

You can search for audio books on the Metropolitan Library System website, just as you would search for print copies. When you click an audio version, you'll be redirected to the Listening to Literature site, where you can download up to three books per session. Or, to streamline the process, install the Listening to Literature app on your smartphone or tablet, and create an account using your Metropolitan Library System card number.

Keep in mind that you don't have to return an audio book the way you return books checked out from the library. Instead, each audio book expires after three weeks. For a demonstration, see Student Name at the Central Library.

Classics in Audio Form

Animal Farm, George Orwell
Bleak House, Charles Dickens
Brave New World, Aldous Huxley
Catcher in the Rye, J.D. Salinger
Crime and Punishment, Fyodor Dostoevsky
Democracy in America, Alexis De Tocqueville
Emma, Jane Austen
Jane Eyre, Charlotte Bronte

In Search of Lost Time, Marcel Proust
Little House on the Prairie, Laura Ingalls Wilder
Little Women, Louisa May Alcott
Middlemarch, George Eliot
Moby Dick, Herman Melville
The Brothers Karamazov, Fyodor Dostoevsky
The Pursuit of Love, Nancy Mitford

The Wind in the Willows, Kenneth Grahame
Their Eyes Were Watching God, Zora Neale Hurston
Things Fall Apart, Chinua Achebe
To the Lighthouse, Virginia Woolf
Under the Sea-Wind, Rachel Carson
War and Peace, Leo Tolstoy
Wuthering Heights, Emily Bronte